

UPSC INDIAN POLITY

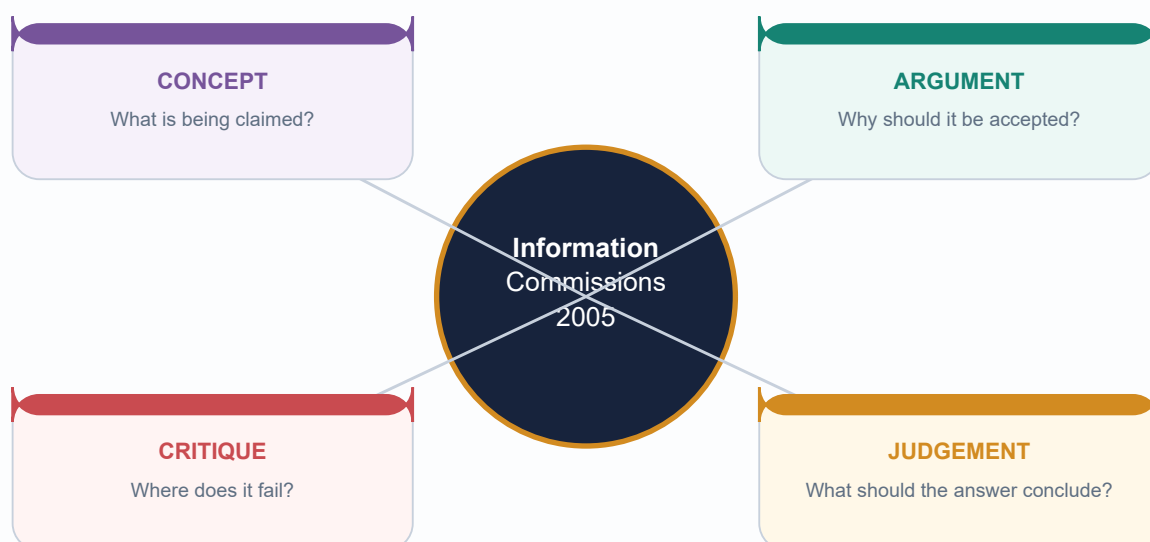
CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: CIC-and-SIC.md + 36_CIC-and-SIC.md

Learning cards: 15



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II***Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.*

STATIC THEORY

• greater than □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/36_CIC-and-SIC.md.*

MEMORY HOOK

greater than □ = from book · □ = current link · = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/36_CIC-and-SIC.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Deep dive → advanced/36_CIC-and-SIC.md.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Law	Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005
Nature	Statutory (not constitutional)
CIC	Chief IC + up to 10 Information Commissioners
CIC appointed by	President (PM + LoP-LS + Union Minister)
Term	3 years , subject to maximum age 65 (2019 Rules)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The **CIC** (central) and **SIC** (state) are the appellate watchdogs of the **RTI regime** — they decide RTI complaints/appeals, have **civil-court powers**, and can **impose penalties**. Their independence was diluted by the **2019 Amendment** (Centre now sets tenure/salary).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

Dimension 1 The CIC (central) and SIC (state) are the appellate watchdogs of the RTI regime — they decide RTI complaints/appeals, have civil-court powers, and can	Dimension 2 greater than □ CIC: President appoints, President removes. SIC: Governor appoints, Governor removes (contrast)
Dimension 3 greater than SHRC = President removes).	Dimension 4 greater than □ The statute permits up to 10 Information Commissioners besides the Chief;

STATIC THEORY

- greater than □ **CIC**: President appoints, President removes. **SIC**: Governor appoints, **Governor removes** (contrast)
- greater than SHRC = President removes).
- greater than □ The statute permits up to **10** Information Commissioners besides the Chief;
- greater than the post-2019 service conditions are prescribed by Central rules.

MEMORY HOOK

greater than **CIC**: President appoints, President removes. **SIC**: Governor appoints, Governor removes (contrast | greater than The statute permits up to 10 Information Commissioners besides the Chief;

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

- Statutory body — RTI Act 2005.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

Dimension 1 ☐ Statutory body — RTI Act 2005.	Dimension 2 ☐ CIC panel = PM + LoP (Lok Sabha) + Union Cabinet Minister; SIC panel = CM + LoP (Assembly) + State
Dimension 3 Minister.	Dimension 4 ☐ Civil-court powers; can examine any public record; can penalise and award compensation.

STATIC THEORY

- ☐ CIC panel = **PM + LoP (Lok Sabha) + Union Cabinet Minister**; SIC panel = ****CM + LoP (Assembly) + State**
- Minister**.
- ☐ **Civil-court powers**; can examine any public record; can **penalise** and award **compensation**.
- ☐ Submits **annual report** → Parliament / State Legislature.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Statutory body — RTI Act 2005.
2. CIC panel = **PM + LoP (Lok Sabha) + Union Cabinet Minister**; SIC panel = ****CM + LoP (Assembly) + State**
3. **Civil-court powers**; can examine any public record; can **penalise** and award **compensation**.
4. Submits **annual report** → Parliament / State Legislature.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation • ☐ Current linkGS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

☐ ☐ The **RTI Amendment Act, 2019** delegated tenure/service conditions to Central rules; the **RTI Rules, 2019** prescribe **three years**, with the statutory age ceiling of 65. ☐ ☐ **DPDP Act, 2023 section 44(3)** substituted RTI section 8(1)(j) with effect from **13 Nov 2025** under MeitY's commencement notification. The new text exempts "information which relates to personal information"; its interaction with the RTI Act's public-interest override and constitutional right-to-information doctrine remains contested. (*Official Gazette status checked 21 Jul 2026.*)

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of ☐ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → ☐ Current link

HIGH

Advanced • Core Foundation

GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

greater than **Subject:** Polity • **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) • **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

Dimension 1

greater than Subject: Polity • Tier: Advanced (exam depth) •
GS Paper: GS-II

Dimension 2

greater than Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch.
57–58 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) +
official updates.

Dimension 3

greater than □ = from source book • □□ = inference / analysis
• □ = current affairs.

Dimension 4

greater than Companion: basic/CIC-and-SIC.md.

STATIC THEORY

- greater than **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 57–58 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official updates.
- greater than □ = from source book • □□ = inference / analysis • □ = current affairs.
- greater than *Companion: basic/CIC-and-SIC.md.*
- greater than
- greater than □□ **Note:** CIC & SIC are **statutory** bodies (RTI Act, 2005) — **NOT constitutional**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. greater than = from source book • □□ = inference / analysis • □ = current affairs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** →
Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced • PART A — CENTRAL INFORMATION
COMMISSION (CIC) □GS-II Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Established **2005** under the **Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005** — a **high-powered independent statutory body** that decides **complaints & appeals** on offices/PSUs/financial institutions under the **Centre & UTs**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Established **2005** under the **Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005** — a **high-powered independent statutory body** that decides **complaints & appeals** on offices/PSUs/financial institutions under the **Centre & UTs**.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** →
PART A — CENTRAL INFORMATION COMMISSION (CIC) □

HIGH**Advanced · Composition**

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Point	Detail
□ Members	Chief Information Commissioner (CIC) + up to 10 Information Commissioners
□ Appointed by	President , on a 3-member committee: PM (chair) + LoP (Lok Sabha) + a Union Cabinet Minister
□ Eligibility	Eminence in public life (law, science, social service, media, admin...); not an MP/MLA, no office of profit/party/business
□ Re-appointment	NOT eligible

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** →
Composition

HIGH**Advanced · Tenure & removal** □ □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Term = 3 years** under the **RTI Rules, 2019**, subject to the statutory maximum age of **65**.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

TENURE & REMOVAL □□: RECALL MAP

Tenure & removal □□

Dimension 1 □ Term = 3 years under the RTI Rules, 2019, subject to the statutory maximum age of 65.	Dimension 2 □□ The RTI (Amendment) Act, 2019 removed the earlier fixed 5-year term and the salary parity with the Election Commission, making tenure, salary & ser
Dimension 3 □ Removed by the President; for proved misbehaviour/incapacity, a Supreme Court inquiry is required.	

STATIC THEORY

- □□ The RTI (Amendment) Act, 2019 removed the earlier **fixed 5-year term** and the salary parity with the **Election Commission**, making **tenure, salary & service conditions decided by the Central Government** — widely criticised as **undermining the CIC's independence** and turning it into a subordinate body.
- □ Removed by the **President**; for **proved misbehaviour/incapacity**, a **Supreme Court inquiry** is required.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Removed by the **President**; for **proved misbehaviour/incapacity**, a **Supreme Court inquiry** is required.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** →
 Tenure & removal □□

HIGH

Advanced · Powers & functions □

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Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Receive & inquire into **complaints** (no PIO, refusal, delay, unreasonable fees, false/incomplete info); **suo-motu** inquiry; **civil-court powers**; can examine **any public record** (none can be withheld); **secure compliance** — order disclosure, appoint a PIO, **impose penalties**, award **compensation**; submits an **annual report** → Parliament.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** →
 Powers & functions □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — STATE INFORMATION COMMISSION (SIC) □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Point	Detail
□ Members	State CIC + up to 10 State Information Commissioners
□ Appointed by	Governor , on a committee: CM (chair) + LoP (Assembly) + a State Cabinet Minister
□ Removed by	GOVERNOR (for proved misbehaviour → SC inquiry)
□ Term	3 years under the 2019 Rules / maximum age 65

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → **PART B — STATE INFORMATION COMMISSION (SIC) □**

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — STATE INFORMATION COMMISSION (SIC) □

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INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Also under the RTI Act, at the **state level** — decides appeals/complaints on **state government** offices.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

• □ **Crucial distinction:** SIC members are **appointed AND removed by the Governor** — **UNLIKE** the **SHRC**, whose members the Governor appoints but only the **President** can remove.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Also under the RTI Act, at the **state level** — decides appeals/complaints on **state government** offices.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → **PART B — STATE INFORMATION COMMISSION (SIC) □**

HIGH

Advanced • UPSC Traps

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Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

it; the **RTI Rules, 2019** currently prescribe **3 years**, subject to age 65.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: CIC/SIC are constitutional bodies

CORRECT: **statutory** (RTI Act 2005).

WRONG: CIC's term remains 5 years

CORRECT: after the **2019 Amendment**, Central rules prescribe

WRONG: CIC salary equals the Election Commissioners'

CORRECT: that **parity was removed** by the 2019 Amendment.

WRONG: CIC can have unlimited Information Commissioners

CORRECT: **max 10** (+ the Chief).

WRONG: SIC members are removed by the President

CORRECT: removed by the **Governor** (contrast SHRC = President).

WRONG: CIC/IC are eligible for re-appointment

CORRECT: **not eligible**.

WRONG: The Leader of Opposition is not on the CIC panel

CORRECT: the **LoP (LS)** is on the 3-member selection committee.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced • □ CA hooks

GS-II Indian
Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **RTI (Amendment) Act, 2019** — Centre controls tenure/salary → the **independence** debate. □ □ **DPDP Act, 2023 section 44(3)** substituted RTI section 8(1)(j) with effect from **13 Nov 2025** under MeitY's commencement notification. The new text exempts information relating to personal information; its interaction with the public-interest override and constitutional right-to-information doctrine remains contested.

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ □ □ **Vacancies & pendency** in the CIC/SICs — several commissions functioning below strength or defunct, delaying

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- appeals (SC has flagged this).

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** → [□](#)
CA hooks

HIGH**Advanced · Mains angles****GS-II** Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"The RTI Act empowered citizens; recent amendments risk disempowering the commissions." Examine (2019 & DPDP 2023). Information Commissions vs the right to privacy (DPDP Act) — balancing transparency and data protection. Vacancies in Information Commissions: a slow death of the RTI regime?

STUDY LINK

CIC & SIC — Information Commissions (RTI Act, 2005) — **ADVANCED / COMPLETE** →
Mains angles

End of Register Notes — UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI